

eBay: bans that land almost immediately after account creation

What the available first-hand reports and marketplace reporting actually say — the mechanisms, the exact wording eBay sends, and how to open an account that survives day one.

READ THIS FIRST — SOURCING LIMITATION

Reddit could not be searched or read for this brief. Three separate routes were attempted and all are closed to automated retrieval:

- **reddit.com** — refuses this user agent outright ("You've been blocked by network security... log in or use your developer token"), and Reddit results are filtered out of the available web-search index entirely.
- **Public Reddit front-ends** (redlib / saferreddit / libreddit instances) — every reachable instance sits behind an *Anubis* proof-of-work challenge explicitly deployed to stop AI scrapers. These were not circumvented, by design.
- **Archive APIs and alternate search engines** — PullPush returned a paid-only rate-limit refusal; DuckDuckGo's HTML endpoints returned CAPTCHAs.

So this brief is built on **the closest available equivalent evidence**: first-hand seller reports on eBay's own public community forums, independent marketplace journalism (Value Added Resource, EcommerceBytes), and vendor guides. Every claim is labelled by source type and reliability. **If you paste Reddit thread links or their text, they can be merged into a v2 of this document.**

Summary of findings

1. **"Instant ban on a brand-new account" is a real, recurring, well-documented pattern** — reported continuously on eBay's own forums, not an isolated glitch.
2. **The single most common cause is account linkage**, not anything the new account did. eBay ties a new registration to an already-suspended one and closes it, often within hours and before any listing goes live.
3. **Linkage is inferred from far more than name and email**: device, browser fingerprint, IP address (including shared/public Wi-Fi and household networks), phone number, postal address, and bank/payout details.
4. **eBay's stated policy makes the household itself a risk surface** — it reserves the right to suspend accounts opened by anyone in the same household as, or associated with, a suspended member.
5. **Creating any new account while another is restricted is itself a violation**, which compounds: each new registration adds a fresh violation rather than a fresh start.
6. **The second cause is verification failure, not misconduct** — the **MC011** hold means identity and/or financial details could not be verified. New accounts trip it constantly on name/bank/address mismatches.
7. **Automated enforcement produces false positives at scale**, and journalism covering the space documents accounts with 20-year histories permanently closed in error, with generic responses in place of a stated reason.

8. **You will almost never be told the actual reason.** The wording is deliberately non-specific to protect the detection system, and support is repeatedly described as unable to add detail.
9. **Appeal odds are poor once "permanent" is used** — except where the cause is verification (MC011), which is genuinely fixable with correct documents.
0. **Category matters enormously for apparel.** Sports jerseys sit in the highest-enforcement zone on eBay: VeRO rights-owner complaints plus a zero-tolerance replica/counterfeit rule. A single strike on a new account can end it.

The reported pattern, case by case

Dates on eBay's forum are shown relatively by the platform; they are reproduced honestly below rather than converted into false precision. **Recency is mixed** — the forum reports span several years, while the 2026 material is journalism and guidance rather than individual ban reports.

SOURCE	DATE	WHAT HAPPENED	WORDING / ATTRIBUTED CAUSE
eBay Community — <i>Help Needed: Permanent Account Suspension with No Appeal Option</i> 1	~1 yr ago FORUM	Account suspended and tied to an old account (anpa_816); no detail given on why the original was suspended, and no route to resolve it. Poster: "eBay says I need to resolve the suspension on the original account, but I've never received any details or steps on how to do that."	eBay: "your account was restricted or suspended because you have a previous account that's still suspended, or you're allowing a suspended member to use your account."
Value Added Resource — <i>Verification Errors & Banned Accounts</i> 2	Liz Morton JOURNALISM	Reported in waves. One seller, Martin Duncanson , was instantly and permanently banned on a newly created UK business account with zero activity — "Never made a single buy, nothing to sell." Others could not get past the verification page at all.	Ban cited "behaviour posing a risk to the community." Article attributes the wave to over-aggressive automated verification and "AI powered dragnets" catching legitimate accounts.
eBay Community — <i>eBay account has been permanently suspended!</i> 3	~3 yrs ago FORUM	Newly opened Business account killed mid-inventory-buying, while the poster's decades-old personal account stayed active and in good standing.	eBay: "your eBay account has been permanently suspended because of activity that we believe was putting the eBay community at risk." Support said "there is nothing they can do" and ended the call.
Replies in that same thread 3	— PEER	The two most upvoted explanations, verbatim: "Most of the time, immediate suspensions like that are because your account was linked to another account that has already been banned." · "Have you ever shared your computer with a family member or friend who was suspended by eBay? Have you ever used public WiFi to do any of your eBay business? If so, you may have been suspended because you have a connection to and/or share an IP address with someone who was suspended."	

SOURCE	DATE	WHAT HAPPENED	WORDING / ATTRIBUTED CAUSE
eBay Community — <i>Account permanently suspended without explanation</i> 4	~4 yrs ago FORUM	Listed two books . Restricted 1 hour and 4 minutes later . Suspected triggers were mundane: an address ZIP change, edits to listing measurements, possibly a mistyped SSN.	eBay: "you have been temporarily restricted from selling and buying on eBay because of concerns about your seller account", then "we found indications of risk to the eBay community" and "We can't provide specific information on what behaviors we have found."
eBay Community — <i>New account suspended for no apparent reason?</i> 5	~4 yrs ago FORUM	Couple opened a new business account over a weekend, listed 5–6 household items (clothing, shoes, a games console). By that evening all listings were pulled and the account was permanently suspended. Their personal account: 100% feedback, no restrictions.	Same permanent-suspension boilerplate: "activity that we believe was putting the eBay community at risk."
eBay Community — <i>Suspended account for unknown reason even without listing</i> 6	~4 yrs ago FORUM	Account opened, left dormant for months with no listings at all , then suspended.	No reason supplied. Consistent with registration-time linkage or verification scoring rather than conduct.
Value Added Resource — <i>Online Sellers' Bill of Rights</i> 7	22 Jul 2026 upd. 1 Aug JOURNALISM	Frames the whole problem as structural: sellers face "vague, unpredictable, and ever-changing rules." Includes a seller suspended for being unable to produce a receipt for art bought 20+ years earlier, and the author's own forum account permanently banned with no warning, then restored only because of her public profile.	Draft legislation targets exactly this: cases where "technical or verification errors wrongly trigger shop suspensions", and would force platforms to "identify the policy allegedly violated and provide the relevant facts and documentation."

Why it happens — five mechanisms, most common first

❶ Linkage to an already-suspended account

The dominant cause in every source reviewed. eBay decides at registration whether the new account "is" a returning suspended user, and closes it if the answer looks like yes. What gets matched:

- Name, email, phone number
- Device and browser fingerprint
- Postal / billing address
- IP address — including shared household and public Wi-Fi
- Bank account and payout details
- Household members and known associates
- Payment instruments
- Behavioural similarity to the closed account

TWO POLICY POINTS THAT CATCH HONEST PEOPLE

- **Household and associate liability.** eBay reserves the right to suspend accounts opened by anyone in the same household as a suspended member, or by their associates. Being innocent is not the test; being linked is.
- **Same-owner accounts must never interact.** Multiple accounts are allowed in principle — but buying from your own second account, or cross-feedback between them, is a reliable way to link and lose both.

The compounding trap: opening a new account while *any* of your accounts is restricted is itself a violation, regardless of what details you register with. Each attempt is a new violation, which is why sellers describe endless loops of accounts dying on creation.

❷ MC011 — identity / financial verification hold

Frequently mistaken for a ban, and the one category that is reliably fixable. MC011 means eBay "*needs to verify your identity, your financial information, or both before allowing you to continue selling.*" Documented triggers on new accounts ❸ :

- Account name not matching the linked bank account
- Address mismatch across eBay account, payment method and ID document
- Rapid listing activity on a fresh account, especially high-value items
- Logins from new locations or devices inconsistent with account history
- Sudden shifts in selling pattern — the cited example is jumping from \$50 to \$500 items

Reported fix: one clean submission through eBay's official upload form — government ID, a bank statement from the last 90 days, proof of address that matches the account exactly, uncropped and unexpired — then wait 24–48 hours **without** firing off duplicate appeals.

❸ Automated enforcement, and its false positives

Enforcement is machine-driven and errs toward closure. The reporting documents an AI dragnet permanently suspending a 20-year seller in error, verification systems that fail on legitimate accounts, and — per Value Added Resource's 2026 coverage — accounts placed on indefinite hold with no meaningful ability to appeal. Suspensions arrive in waves, which is consistent with model or rule changes rather than individual seller behaviour.

4 A new account that behaves like a bad actor

The risk model reads a new account's first hours as a signal. The profile that draws instant scrutiny: brand-new account, immediate high-volume or high-value listings, mismatched or hard-to-verify details, a VPN or unusual geography, connection details that don't cohere, and heavy third-party API automation from day one.

5 Category risk — acute for jerseys and sports apparel

DIRECTLY RELEVANT IF THE ACCOUNT IS FOR JERSEY SALES

Sports apparel is one of eBay's most heavily policed categories, on two independent tracks:

- **VeRO** — the Verified Rights Owner programme lets thousands of participating brands, leagues and clubs pull listings directly. A single strike can mean listing removal, account restriction or permanent suspension; on a brand-new account with no track record there is no goodwill to absorb it.
- **Replica / counterfeit** — a flat prohibition with no exceptions, defined as items not made by the manufacturer whose name the product carries. Team names, crests, logos, player names and numbers are all rights-holder IP.

Practical consequence: a new account listing unlicensed or ambiguously-sourced jerseys is close to the worst-case profile for surviving week one. Words like "replica", "fan version", "unbranded copy", or team marks used in titles without licence are exactly what the automated screens look for.

The exact messages, and what each one means

"We wanted to let you know that your eBay account has been permanently suspended because of activity that we believe was putting the eBay community at risk."

The permanent-suspension boilerplate. Carries no information about cause. Appears in reports spanning years, worldwide.

"your account was restricted or suspended because you have a previous account that's still suspended, or you're allowing a suspended member to use your account."

The clearest signal you can get: this is linkage. The named prior account must be resolved first — which is where sellers get stuck, because the reason for the original suspension is often never disclosed.

"you have been temporarily restricted from selling and buying on eBay because of concerns about your seller account"

Restriction, not termination. Often verification- or risk-scoring-driven, and the state in which action is still worth taking.

"we found indications of risk to the eBay community" / "We can't provide specific information on what behaviors we have found."

Support's standard position. The opacity is deliberate — disclosing the trigger would let bad actors engineer around detection. Do not expect escalation to produce specifics.

"MC011"

Not a ban. A verification hold, and the most recoverable outcome on this list.

What the evidence says about appealing

- **Verification holds (MC011): good odds.** Correct documents, submitted once, through the official form.
- **Linkage suspensions: poor odds** unless you can actually document separation — different identity, different financial details, no shared device, network or address. Reports of eBay reversing a linkage call

are rare.

- **"Permanent" language: treat as final.** Sellers consistently report being told the decision cannot be appealed and no further detail will be given. The one restoration in the material reviewed happened because the person was a journalist with public reach — not through the standard process.
- **Do not open replacement accounts while appealing.** It converts an arguable case into an unarguable one, and each attempt adds a violation.
- **Never share a device, network or payout detail with a suspended seller,** including inside your own household — this is the mechanism that manufactures linkage out of nothing.

Checklist: opening an account that survives day one

BEFORE YOU REGISTER

- Confirm no account tied to your name, address, phone, bank details or household is currently suspended or restricted. If one is, resolve it first — registering now is a violation in itself.
- Register on a clean device on your own network. No VPN, no public Wi-Fi, no borrowed or shared computer.
- Make identity details match **exactly** across eBay account, bank account, payment method and ID document — legal name, address, spelling, formatting.
- Have verification documents ready in advance: government ID, bank statement from the last 90 days, proof of address.

FIRST 30 DAYS

- Complete identity and payout verification before listing anything.
- Start small and ramp gradually. Do not open with high-value inventory or bulk uploads.
- Hold off on third-party API automation until the account has history.
- Log in from one consistent device and location.
- If you run more than one account, keep them entirely non-interacting — no purchases, no feedback, no shared payout details between them.

APPAREL AND JERSEYS SPECIFICALLY

- List only stock whose provenance you can document, and be able to produce supplier invoices on request — sellers have been suspended for failing to evidence ownership.
- Check the VeRO participant list for every brand, league and club before listing.
- Never use "replica", "fan version", or equivalent framing; never use team marks, crests or player names in titles without a licence.
- Use your own photography. Copied images are themselves a VeRO complaint route.
- Treat the first VeRO strike as existential on a young account — dispute or remove immediately.

How much to trust each source

SOURCE TYPE	RELIABILITY	NOTES
eBay Community forum posts	HIGH FOR LIVED EXPERIENCE	Genuine first-hand reports with verbatim eBay message text. Weakness: one-sided — the poster's own triggering conduct may be unknown or unstated. Platform shows dates relatively, and several key threads are years old and moderator-closed.
Value Added Resource / EcommerceBytes	HIGH	Independent marketplace journalism (Liz Morton, Ina Steiner). Named sellers, dated reporting, sceptical of platform claims. The most credible material here, and the most recent (July–August 2026).
Forum peer explanations	MEDIUM	Experienced sellers, and remarkably consistent with each other and with eBay's own policy language — but not authoritative. eBay does not confirm detection mechanics.
Vendor / SEO "2026 guide" pages	LOW	Dropshipping tools, anti-detect browsers, automation vendors. Useful for enumerating categories of cause; unreliable on specifics, frequently recycled between sites, and several have a commercial interest in encouraging exactly the multi-account behaviour that causes these bans.
Reddit	NOT RETRIEVED	Zero Reddit content is included in this brief. See the sourcing note on page 1. Nothing here should be read as representing what Reddit says.

Sources

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- 4 eBay Community — "Account permanently suspended without explanation" (~4 years ago, closed)
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- 5 eBay Community — "New account suspended for no apparent reason?" (~4 years ago, closed)
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- 6 eBay Community — "HELP: Suspended account for unknown reason even without listing"
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- 7 Value Added Resource — "Online Sellers' Bill Of Rights Targets Marketplace Holds, Suspensions And Policy Changes" — Liz Morton, 22 July 2026 (updated 1 Aug 2026)
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- 8 Underpriced — "eBay Account Suspended 2026: Fix MC011 in 3 Steps" — updated 29 July 2026 (vendor guide)
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- 9 eBay Community — "eBay suspend all new accounts i register" · "eBay keeps banning my accounts and will not explain why" · "Account Restricted – Linked Account" — thread cluster on repeat registration bans
community.ebay.com/t5/Selling/eBay-suspend-all-new-accounts-i-register/td-p/33312336
- 10 Value Added Resource — "eBay Pill Press AI Dragnet Permanently Suspends 20 Year Seller In Error" and "eBay Seller Suspended Over 20 Year Old Art With No Receipt" — automated-enforcement false positives
valueaddedresource.net/ebay-pill-press-ai-dragnet-suspends-seller-in-error/

